

LIVE



NEWSPAPER

27th October, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

43rd WEEK



ANO **BUDE LÍP**
POLITICKÉ HNUTÍ

MIGRATION REVERBERATIONS IN CZECH

UPSC CSE – GS II

**GS II... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF DEVELOPING
COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS.**



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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

27th OCTOBER, 2017

1

Czech churn

A billionaire businessman could unsettle the establishment in Prague

Electing businessmen who claim to offer something better than the established order is not just an American temptation, as the results of last week's parliamentary election in the Czech Republic show. Billionaire Andrej Babiš's party ANO (Action for Dissatisfied Citizens, but ano is also Czech for "yes") won 30% of the vote, making the second richest man in the Czech Republic its most likely future Prime Minister. Mr. Babiš's business ventures include food, chemicals, two of the country's leading newspapers, radio stations and a news portal. While ANO is part of the outgoing coalition, he established a political foothold on an anti-establishment and anti-corruption platform, promising to cut through cronyism and to run the state more like a business. Ironically, Mr. Babiš himself is embroiled in controversies. He is currently being investigated by the European Union for his alleged misuse of EU subsidies in financing a construction project. How Mr. Babiš, who during the 1990s used to work for a state trading company in what is now Slovakia, established himself so powerfully in the business world following the formation of the Czech Republic in 1993 is unclear. Slovakia's top constitutional court has recently overturned a decision by lower courts to exonerate him of ties with the StB, the former communist regime's secret police. This is likely to complicate an already complex situation following last week's vote, which saw mainstream parties taking a beating. Given the fractured mandate, ANO will need at least two other parties to form a viable coalition.

The Social Democrats, who have led the incumbent government in a coalition with ANO and the Christian Democrats, got just 7.3% of the vote, down from 20.5% in 2013. The election has also seen the growth of the far-right Freedom and Direct Democracy Party (SPD), which won about 11% of the vote. The party, run by Tokyo-born Tomio Okamura, wants to take the Czech Republic out of the EU, bring immigration down to zero and ban propagation of Islam. Despite the fact that the Czech economy is doing reasonably well and there is low unemployment, candidates have played on fears around immigration. Mr. Babiš himself used this to his advantage during the campaign. Mr. Babiš has indicated he is pro-EU and pro-NATO but is against the bloc's migration policies, has ruled out joining the euro and seems to view the EU mostly through the prism of trade. The relationship with Brussels is tense, with the EU already having started infringement proceedings against the country for not accepting its share of migrants to the EU under a 2015 deal. Meanwhile, the fact that Mr. Babiš has transferred his business to a trust does little to assuage concerns over the power he would wield. Those within the republic as well as in the neighbourhood have legitimate cause for concern.

1 Czech churn

Date : 27th October, 2017

A billionaire businessman could unsettle the establishment in Prague. Electing businessmen who claim to offer something better than the established order is not just an American temptation, as the results of last week's parliamentary election in the Czech Republic show. Billionaire Andrej Babiš's party ANO (Action for Dissatisfied Citizens, but ano is also Czech for "yes") won 30% of the vote, making the second richest man in the Czech Republic its most likely future Prime Minister. Mr. Babiš's business ventures include food, chemicals, two of the country's leading newspapers, radio stations and a news portal. While ANO is part of the outgoing coalition, he established a political foothold on an anti-establishment and anti-corruption platform, promising to cut through cronyism and to run the state more like a business. Ironically, Mr. Babiš himself is embroiled in controversies. He is currently being investigated by the European Union for his alleged misuse of EU subsidies in financing a construction project. How Mr. Babiš, who during the 1980s used to work for a state trading company in what is now Slovakia, established himself so powerfully in the business world following the formation of the Czech Republic in 1993 is unclear. Slovakia's top constitutional court has recently overturned a decision by lower courts to exonerate him of ties with the StB, the former communist regime's secret police. This is likely to complicate an already complex situation following last week's vote, which saw mainstream parties taking a beating. Given the fractured mandate, ANO will need at least two other parties to form a viable coalition.

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ANDREJ BABIS



He is currently being investigated by the European Union for his alleged misuse of EU subsidies in financing a construction project.

BUSINESSMAN BECOMING HEAD OF CZECH REPUBLIC

- 1** Billionaire Andrej Babis' party ANO (Action for Dissatisfied Citizens) won 30% of the vote.
- 2** He is most likely to become the future Prime Minister of Czech Republic.
- 3** His business ventures include food, chemicals, two of the country's leading newspapers, radio stations etc.
- 4** He established a political platform on an anti-establishment and anti-corruption.
- 5** He promised to cut through cronyism and to run the state more like a business.



Norwegian Sea

North Atlantic Ocean

North Sea

FINLAND

NORWAY

SWEDEN

RUSSIA

IRELAND

UNITED KINGDOM

GERMANY

POLAND

BELARUS

CZECH REPUBLIC

SLOVAKIA

UKRAINE

FRANCE

AUSTRIA

HUNGARY

ROMANIA

CROATIA

SLOVENIA

Bosnia and Herzegovina

SERBIA

MACEDONIA

ALBANIA

GREECE

ITALY

IONIAN SEA

ADRIATIC SEA

AEGEAN SEA

Black Sea

TURKEY

Caspian Sea

KAZAKHSTAN

UZBEKISTAN

TURKMENISTAN

REVERBERATIONS OF IMMIGRATION / ANTI ISLAM

- 1** The election has seen the growth of the far-right Freedom and Direct Democracy Party (SPD), which won about 11% of the vote. It wants to take the Czech Republic out of the EU, bring immigration down to zero and ban propagation of Islam.
- 2** Despite the Czech economy is doing reasonably well, candidates have played on fears around immigration.
- 3** Mr. Babis has indicated, he is pro-EU and pro-NATO, but is against the bloc's migration policies.
- 4** He seems to view the EU mostly through the prism of trade.
- 5** Already Brussels started infringement proceedings against the country for not accepting its share of immigrants with in the EU under a 2015 deal.

Mr. Babis has transferred his business to a trust and that does little to assuage concerns over the power he would wield.

FAR LEFT

- 1** The more extreme supporters are advocates of social, political or economic change, reform or revolution designed to promote the greater freedom, power, welfare or comfort of the common people.
- 2** It generally supports social equality, egalitarianism. In general, it opposes social hierarchy and social inequality.
- 3** It works with the belief that there are unjustified inequalities that need to be reduced or abolished, while advocating social justice.

The political terms left and right were coined during the French revolution of 18th century

FAR RIGHT POLITICS

- 1** The term is often associated with extreme nationalist and nativist ideologies.
- 2** They also include authoritarianism, anticommunism.
- 3** The far right has historically favoured an elitist society based on the belief in the legitimacy of the rule of a supposed superior minority over the inferior masses.
- 4** Some aspects of fascist ideology have been identified with right wing political parties. The fascist idea that superior persons should dominate society, while undesirable elements should be purged, which in the case of Nazism resulted in genocide.

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